Andrés Ruiz Palomino

Technical Artist · Unity · VFX · Pipelines · C#

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English: Advanced · Open to full-time remote (USD) · Full US-hours overlap

SUMMARY

Technical artist and Unity developer with 3+ years on the bridge between art and build. Grew from technical artist to lead of the discipline at Zarzilla Games, then shipped Unity titles on mobile and on physical casino cabinets, where every asset had to hold up on three different screen layouts. Works on art implementation, particle VFX, lighting, LODs, optimization and the tools that keep a content pipeline repeatable, and writes the C# behind them, so art reaches the build working instead of coming back as a bug.

CORE SKILLS

Art in engine	Unity 6 / URP · prefabs, materials and import settings · LODs · lighting, baking and post-processing volumes · UI art implementation and scaling across resolutions
VFX & feel	Particle systems · code-driven VFX and animation · shader work (lava, emissive, water) · hitstop, screen shake, hit flash, squash and bounce, animation timing
Pipelines & tools	Reskin pipelines · asset validation · editor tools in C# · runtime and memory optimization · font optimization
Implementation	C#, Unity 6, Git, FMOD · Cocos Creator / TypeScript

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Unity Developer · Vortex Studios, via Upwork — Sep 2026 – Present

Three Unity 6 mobile games for one publisher, weekly deliveries · first contract closed with a 5-star review

- Aqua Match Kingdom (match-3): built the feel layer (falling ease, settle bounce, squash, per-column cascade stagger) tuned against footage of a reference title, with an in-game tuning panel and an exaggerated preset so the client reacts with "more" or "less" instead of numbers.
- Added the combat feedback to Snake Battle Arena (fire breath, embers, bite bursts, popups, haptics); it is live on Google Play, so every delivery ships as a public update. Integrated the designer's art package (arena, walls, cannon model) into Cannon Battle Arena.

Game Programmer · DOB Studios — Mar 2026 – Aug 2026

"Runies Daycare: Merge & Pets" · live-service Unity 6 mobile game, now on Google Play · 12-person team

- Built the game's particle VFX and implemented its UI art, working both sides of the handoff: the art going in and the UI architecture it lives in (the manager every screen routes through, the creature compendium, the exploration map).
- Built the resolution and scale management that keeps that UI correct across device sizes.

Unity Developer · GDP Studios — Jul 2025 – Mar 2026

Unity games for physical casino cabinets, published under GMW · 4 titles shipped

- Shipped 4 titles onto a codebase that had to render across three cabinet models with completely different screen arrangements (three stacked 16:9; 16:9 / 9:16 / 16:9; 9:16 under 16:9), so every asset had to hold up on all three.
- Ran the reskin pipeline for cloned titles (same logic, different art) without letting versions drift apart; drove optimization work, researched font optimization for the cabinet formats, and introduced an art/UX workflow that cut friction studio-wide.

Technical Artist → Lead Technical Artist → Studio Manager · Zarzilla Games — 2023 – 2025

2D mobile games in Cocos Creator · Gin Rummy Super (live)

- Redefined the technical art discipline at the studio: it had been art implementation only, and became a group that also owned the technical work adjacent to art, including tools that sped up the animation team's workflow. Defined technical pipelines and optimized runtime performance and resource usage.
- Pitched several art and VFX proposals that shipped in Gin Rummy Super, and built the entire visual logic of Treasure Mines, a minigame still live in the app.
- As Studio Manager: ran ~15 people across 5 areas (technical art, development, UI/raster art, animation, concept art), with sprint planning and cross-area handoffs.

SELECTED PROJECTS

full detail at arzpal.github.io

Hell Is Mine 2.0 · top-down action, stylized low-poly · final degree project · environment and technical artist — 2022

- Wrote the lava shader and built the emissive terrain, the glowing water and the particle work that give the underworld its look; set up LODs and blocked out the levels as the game designer. Full gameplay video.

CrazyNema · multiplayer prototype · DOB Studios · lighting — Aug 2026

- Diagnosed with numbers why the scene looked nothing like its reference: no post-processing volumes, nothing baked, 737 objects not marked static, flat grey ambient, LDR grading clipping the emissives, and the active URP asset was a bought pack's demo profile. Led the fix: baked lighting, volumes, and a GI patch for a bought toon shader that rendered black once the scene was baked.

Prismonaut · 2D platformer · founder of Naked Dog · 6-person core — Dec 2024 – May 2026

- Founded the studio and worked as designer, environment artist and lead technical artist; directed part of the player effects and visual feedback, and designed and programmed the hazards (slimes, thorn roots, spikes, tutorial lava sequence). Taken from prototype through Game Jam Plus incubation to a Steam build.

Tatemis3D · 3D creature-collector, real-time action combat · solo — Jul 2026 – Present

- Designed the feel layer: hitstop, screen shake, hit flash and damage popups scaled by the weight of the hit, tuned in a dedicated combat lab scene.

EDUCATION

Toulouse Lautrec · Game Design & Digital Entertainment — 2023

ADDITIONAL

- Playable builds on itch.io for Don't Chicken Out!, Prismonaut and Crust and Conflict; gameplay video for six of the projects at arzpal.github.io.